

HALLOWED GROUNDS Students at Delhi University

ARUN KUMAR

INDIA'S MOST IMPROVED UNIVERSITIES*

STREAM	UNIVERSITY
GENERAL (GOVERNMENT)	UNIVERSITY OF LUCKNOW, LUCKNOW
GENERAL (PRIVATE)	SRM INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, KATTANKULATHUR
MEDICAL	NA
TECHNICAL	INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY BANGALORE, BENGALURU
LAW	DAMODARAM SANJIVAYYA NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY, VISAKHAPATNAM

**The university that has shown the highest percentage growth in ranking over the past five years (2020–2025) in the India Today-MDRA Best Universities Ranking*

infrastructure, student engagement as well as placement performance. On a broader scale, it reflects a trend where older, multi-college public universities are reclaiming academic prominence amid India's shifting higher education landscape.

Meanwhile, Aligarh Muslim University has maintained a steady upward trajectory, entrenched in third place since 2021, while the University of Hyderabad has remained firmly in the top four despite minor fluctuations. Osmania University has shown consistent improvement over the years, despite periods of non-participation, and ranks fifth this time. Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University, which made an appearance only in 2021, has rapidly climbed to sixth place in this year's list. Bharathiar University and Acharya Nagarjuna University, on the other hand, have demonstrated remarkable long-term progress, moving up from 18th and 14th positions in 2018 to ninth and 10th, respectively, this year, mirroring the shift toward regional institutions gaining national academic recognition.

THE PRIVATE SPACE

The 2025 Best Universities survey reflects a major churn at the top tier of private general universities. The SRM Institute of Science & Technology in Kattankulathur, Tamil Nadu, emerges as the new No. 1 for the first time since the rankings began, a significant leap from its fourth rank in 2021. Symbiosis International University, Pune, which held the top spot in 2024, has dropped to second place, while Amity University, Noida, a consistent leader from 2019 to 2023, has slipped to third. CHRIST University, Bengaluru, once a front-runner (No. 1 in 2018), continues its gradual descent, coming in fourth this year.

The Koneru Lakshmaiah Education Foundation (KL University) has demonstrated strong upward momentum, jumping from ninth position in 2018 to fifth now. Banasthali Vidyapith maintains its position in the top six, while Sathyabama and JAIN Universities show consistency in the mid-tier ranks. Galgotias University has made a significant climb from 18th place in 2018 to ninth in 2025. XIM University, which was not ranked until 2020, continues its steady presence in the top 10.

The rankings in the medical category reveal a strong consistency at the top, even as new institutions have emerged over the years. AIIMS Delhi retains its unbroken streak at No. 1 from 2018 through 2025, underscoring its unmatched reputation, academic excellence and healthcare leadership. Following closely are JIPMER Puducherry and King George's Medical University, Lucknow, which have